

Warning Forever

<http://www18.big.or.jp/~hikoza/Prod/>

Warning Forever is an amazing shoot 'em up that throws in the mechanic of a boss-rush to make it an absolute must-play for fans of the genre. The game pits you against a constant stream of battles that increase in difficulty as you progress. Each of the game's stages consists of a single boss battle. To progress to the next stage, the boss must be completely destroyed within the time limit. The game starts with a default time limit of 180 seconds, with 30 seconds



rewarded for every boss defeated and 20 seconds lost for each time the player is destroyed. It's fast, it's frantic, it's clever, and it's a lot of fun.

Cave Story

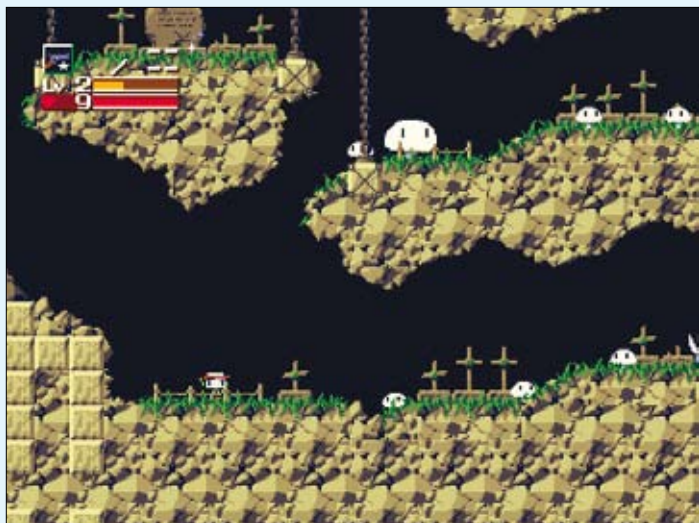
<http://agtp.romhack.net/project.php?id=cavestory>

Cave Story is perhaps synonymous with Indie game development. First release in 2004 by Daisuke Amaya, it is the second Metroidvania game in our list and is perhaps the most sublime game created, not with a large budget, but with over five years of love and attention to detail. Simply put, Cave Story is a must-play for every gamer.

The game starts you off without any weapons but items are soon acquired throughout the game's progress. Jet packs, beam weapons, bubble gun, and so on are some of the



weapons and items that see you through the game's tale of amnesiac robots, bunnies, and power-hungry scientists. The graphics, presentation, and music are deliciously retro and serve to underline the classic roots of this title.



The Underside

<http://www.superfundungeonrun.com/insignificant-studios/preview.php>

Described by the author as an "exploration platform game", *Underside* is a Metroidvania game similar to Castlevania, Metroid, and Cave Story. The difference lies in how progress is made: while classic Metroidvania games reward free-roaming exploration, *Underside* is more driven by plot.



The story revolves around 'Ip' who must make his escape from the Underside, and prevent the world from being destroyed by the world's god—The Universal King—while he's at it. The game's creator, Arthur Lee, claims to have been inspired by the classic *Earthbound* series (also known as *Mother* in Japan) in shaping the game's concept of a flat world turned upside-down. *Underside* sees characters and dialogue that take on a quirky appeal, with a decidedly whimsical plot.

